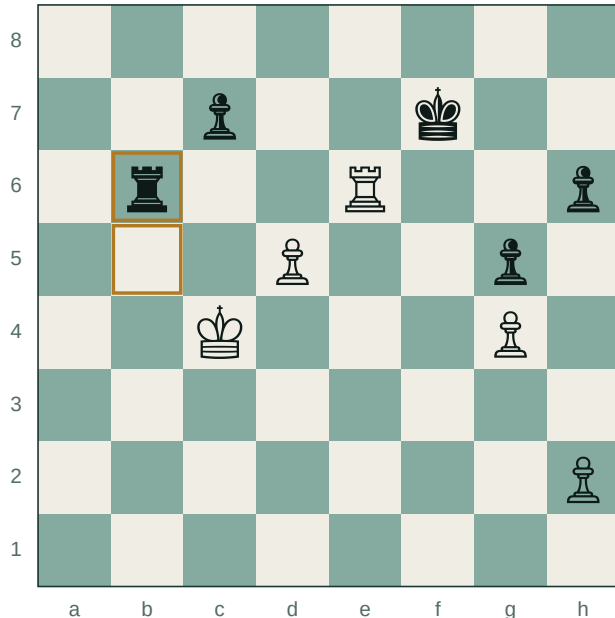


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 36

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 35...Rb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36. Rxb6 cxb6 37. Kb5 Ke7 38. Kc6

36.Rxb6 The rook captures the rook on b6. Recorded reply: **36...cxb6**.

37.Kb5 The king moves from c4 to b5. Recorded reply: **37...Ke7**.

38.Kc6 The king moves from b5 to c6.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on f7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.